Advanced Punctuation (Set B)

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. The rain stopped; the sun came out.
2. We need these items: a pencil, a rubber and a ruler.
3. B) Tom said, "I am ready."
4. (My cousin (born in 2014) loves football.)
5. The dash pair correctly marks off the extra comment "though tiring".
6. "Can we go now?" asked Ben.
7. A) She packed: a hat, gloves and a scarf.; C) She needed three things: time, money and patience.; E) The winners were: Alex, Sam and Mo.
8. C) semicolon
9. "Stop right there!" yelled the guard.
10. A colon introduces the list that follows it, telling the reader 'here come the details'.
11. C) The lights went out; the storm was fierce.
12. The museum (which opens at nine) is free today.
13. Any correct example, e.g. Mum said, "Dinner is ready."
14. A) The match was close — until the final minute.; E) The game ended in a draw — a fair result.
15. It needs a capital letter at the start of the speech and punctuation inside the speech marks: He said, "Hello."

Green — Building Fluency

16. The exam was difficult; most pupils still passed.
17. There was only one explanation: he had forgotten his key.
18. A) "I think," said Mia, "we should leave now."
19. The weather forecast — and it is rarely wrong — predicted snow.
20. A comma can join a main clause to a less formal addition, but a semicolon joins two complete, closely related main clauses, e.g. 'It was raining; we stayed indoors' vs 'It was raining, so we stayed indoors.'
21. A) The bridge (built in 1920) is still standing.; C) The recipe (serves four) takes an hour.; E) Our teacher (Mr Hughes) is very strict.
22. "I cannot believe it," she whispered. "We actually won!"
23. B) colon
24. A dash feels more informal/dramatic and can appear mid-sentence easily, e.g. 'The cake — a chocolate one — was huge.' A colon is more formal and often introduces a list or explanation, e.g. 'He brought one thing: dessert.'
25. The team trained hard; they deserved to win.
26. A) She asked, "Are we late?"
27. There was a simple reason for his lateness: the bus never arrived.
28. A) She loves reading; he prefers films.; C) It was cold; we still went outside.; E) The shop closed early; customers were disappointed.
29. Any correct sentence using a colon before a dramatic statement, e.g. "Then she saw it: a dragon."
30. Any correct sentence punctuated three ways with a dash, brackets and commas, e.g. "My dog — a scruffy terrier — barked." / "My dog (a scruffy terrier) barked." / "My dog, a scruffy terrier, barked."

Red — Challenge

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31. The bell rang; everyone stood up.
32. C) We packed everything we needed: trainers, a towel and sun cream.
33. The sun came out. We went outside to play. (or: The sun came out; we went outside to play.)
34. Our head teacher (Mrs Patel) is retiring this summer.
35. A) The storm passed; the sky cleared.; C) She loves maths; he prefers art.; E) It was late; we carried on walking.
36. Mum called, "Wash your hands before dinner."
37. C) The plan — surprisingly — worked perfectly.
38. A colon introduces the list that explains what the 'three things' are (a map, a torch and some water).
39. There was one reason for the delay: the bus broke down.
40. A) 'I think,' said Tom, 'we should go home.'
41. Any correct sentence with a colon before a list, e.g. 'She packed three things: a hat, gloves and a scarf.'
42. A) The film (which won an award) was excellent.; C) Our dog (a spaniel) loves the park.; E) The bridge (built in 1950) is still used.
43. "Watch out!" shouted the coach.
44. A comma alone cannot join two complete sentences (this would be a comma splice); a semicolon can, e.g. 'It was cold; we stayed inside.'
45. The rain stopped; the children ran outside.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. The wind dropped; the sea grew calm.
2. Pack these items: a jumper, a hat and gloves.
3. B) Sam said, "I am tired."
4. (My teacher (who studied in France) speaks fluent French.)
5. The dash pair correctly marks off the extra comment "though long".
6. "Is dinner ready?" asked Mia.
7. A) He packed: trainers, shorts and a towel.; C) He needed three things: focus, time and energy.; E) The winners were: Jo, Alex and Sam.
8. C) semicolon
9. "Wait for me!" called Noah.
10. A colon introduces the list that follows it.
11. C) The power failed; the lightning was fierce.
12. The library (which opens at ten) is free to join.
13. Any correct example, e.g. Dad said, "Breakfast is ready."
14. A) The race was close — until the last lap.; E) The match ended in a tie — a fair result.
15. It needs a capital letter at the start of the speech and punctuation inside the speech marks: She said, "Finally."

Green — Building Fluency

16. The test was tricky; most students still did well.
17. There was only one reason he was smiling: he had passed.
18. A) "I believe," said Omar, "we can win."
19. The weather report — and it is usually accurate — predicted sunshine.
20. A comma can join a main clause to a less formal addition, but a semicolon joins two complete, closely related main clauses. Accept any correct equivalent example.
21. A) The tower (built in 1890) still stands.; C) The recipe (serves six) takes two hours.; E) Our coach (Mrs Lane) is very encouraging.
22. "I cannot believe it," he gasped. "We actually won!"
23. B) colon
24. A dash feels more informal/dramatic; a colon is more formal and often introduces a list or explanation. Accept any correct equivalent examples.
25. The choir practised daily; they deserved to win.
26. A) He asked, "Are we lost?"
27. There was a simple reason for the delay: the train broke down.
28. A) He likes football; she prefers tennis.; C) It was late; we still finished the walk.; E) The shop opened late; customers waited outside.
29. Any correct sentence using a colon before a dramatic statement.
30. Any correct sentence punctuated three ways with a dash, brackets and commas.

Standard / Advanced

31. It's time to go; the bus is waiting. (two errors: 'Its' needs an apostrophe to mean 'it is', and the comma splice needs a semicolon or full stop.)
32. B) The teacup (the one Gran gave us) is cracked.
33. "Are we nearly there?" she asked.

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34. He had one wish: to pass the test.

35. The library was silent. Suddenly the fire alarm rang. (or: …silent; suddenly…)

36. (a) The rain stopped; the sun came out. (b) A semicolon works because both parts are complete sentences of equal importance, closely linked in meaning.

37. (a) "Stop right there!" he shouted. (b) The exclamation mark goes inside the speech marks, straight after 'there'.

38. B) He needed two things: a pen and paper.

39. A) The match restarted; the rain had stopped.; C) The match restarted: the rain had stopped.; E) The match restarted — the rain had stopped.

40. A) The cake — a birthday gift — was delicious.; C) Our coach — Mr Lee — is very strict.; E) The match — despite the rain — went ahead.

41. (a) The team was ready; the whistle blew and the game began. (b) It was a comma splice — a comma was used to join two complete sentences, which a comma alone cannot do.

42. (a) "Are you ready?" asked Leo. (b) "Yes, I am," replied Nina.

43. (a) The cave was pitch dark; everyone felt uneasy. (or a full stop and capital letter) (b) A comma cannot join two complete sentences on its own — this would create a comma splice.

44. A) The shop (now closed) sold one thing: postcards.

45. He said, "We should hurry up. The gates close at six." — speech marks go around the exact words spoken, with a capital letter to start the speech and a full stop before the closing speech mark.

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